

Chapter 51-4

Liang Shi suddenly opened her eyes.

It was dawn.

But the rain outside hadn't stopped yet. Dark clouds still covered the sky, and the clock on the wall pointed to 7:32. Outside it still looked like perfect weather for sleeping, but Liang Shi had just awakened from her dream. She raised her hand to wipe her forehead—it was covered in cold sweat.

She forced herself to sit up, then went to the bathroom to take a shower.

The moment she got out of bed, her legs went weak and she almost fell to her knees.

She took a cold shower in the bathroom, as if only this could calm her down.

Last night's dream had too great an impact on her, and she still felt shaken after waking up.

After showering, she casually wrapped herself in a bathrobe and came out, taking the bloody button from the bedside drawer.

Under the bright light, she could see its original color from the edges.

The original color was blue.

Just like the button that had appeared in her dream.

That wasn't a dream—it was the original host's memory.

Liang Shi had once again obtained part of the original host's memories, and this part carried endless pain.

Even she, an outsider, was moved to pain by it.

Liang Shi seemed to have grasped the pattern for triggering the original host's memories.

After returning to the room at the old residence, she had triggered memories with Zhou Yi'an and Xu Qingzhu.

After seeing the bloody button, she had triggered memories related to the button.

In other words, at key locations or when she touched key objects, the original host's memories would be triggered.

Liang Shi's heart jumped, and she immediately asked the system: "Did you give me the original host's memories?"

After a while, the system's eerie mechanical voice sounded in her mind: 【You don't have the original host's memories?】

Its tone was extremely shocked!

Liang Shi: "No, I've been living blindly this whole time."

The chatty system from before had returned: 【No wonder you've been so OOC¹ all along. So you didn't have her memories. But given your personality, even if you had her memories, you'd still be OOC.】

Liang Shi listened with a headache and said sternly: "Shut up! Get to the point."

System: 【...】

The system was silent for two seconds, then said seriously: 【Sorry host, the original host's memories are not under the jurisdiction of the Resentment Management Bureau. It's up to her to decide whether to grant them.】

"She still has the right to choose?" Liang Shi was shocked.

System: 【From a regulatory standpoint, every person has human rights. The Resentment Management Bureau's human rights laws are very comprehensive. We respect others' privacy and choices.】

Liang Shi found a loophole in its words: "What about privately?"

System: 【...】

【We also respect her choices, because we can only imprison her soul, not take her memories.】
the system said.

Liang Shi rubbed her forehead helplessly, then asked: "So you won't give me a rundown of this book's content?"

System: 【Don't you already know the general content?】

Liang Shi's good temper was gradually disappearing: "I want the details! For example, the relationship between the original host and Qiu Zimin, the original host's background, and what happened after the real daughter came back. Please tell me, thank you."

The system fell silent again.

Liang Shi questioned: "Why can't you tell me?"

The system answered in an eerie voice: 【Have you ever seen anyone write extensively about cannon fodder? Including her background, her past—cannon fodder exists to be abused, to serve as support for the protagonists and then exit the stage.】

Liang Shi: "..."

If the system had a physical form, it would definitely get beaten up.

But after the system disappeared, Liang Shi understood the deeper meaning of its words.

For that book, Liang Shi was just cannon fodder.

There wouldn't be much space devoted to her, so her past wasn't important. Her future was to be cannon fodder, following the timeline to exit the stage.

But for Liang Shi, this was the life she was currently experiencing, the people and events she was dealing with.

Perhaps before, she had still been hesitating about whether to uncover the mysteries surrounding the original host.

She was human, so naturally she had selfish traits.

For her, staying away from the Liang family and not caring about those matters would naturally be best.

But after seeing the original host lying on the ground like a madwoman, she finally made her decision.

She wanted to figure these things out.

Why exactly did Qiu Zimin subject a child to such cruel torment? And why had she existed in this world before?

What exactly had happened between her and the original host?

Who were the original host's biological parents? Why exactly had the original host become that stupid and vicious cannon fodder?

For the author, it might just be one sentence.

But for the original host, for Liang Shi, it was an extremely long lifetime.

Liang Shi would have to live with her original identity going forward, so giving her justice was the only thing she could do for her.

Liang Shi put that button in her pocket and asked Zhao Xuning where there were suitable places for age verification testing.

She smoothly contacted an expert.

While eating breakfast, Xu Qingzhu noticed that Liang Shi had a sharp edge about her.

Before, she had been gentle, like water, very zen-like, not caring about anything.

But at this moment, she seemed to have something she wanted to protect.

"What happened in one night?" Xu Qingzhu wondered.

She carried this thought with her as she left for work.

Footnotes:

¹ OOC: "Out of Character" - a term meaning acting differently from one's established personality or character traits.